

to an ecstatic finale, it has become his most enduringly popular work. This triumphant resumption of his composing career was accompanied by happiness in love—in 1902, he married his cousin Natalia Satina.

As a wedding gift, his aristocratic parents-in-law (who were also his aunt and uncle) gave him a house on their country estate at Ivanovka, about 300 miles (480 km) from Moscow, which he had been visiting since 1890. This proved an ideal summer home, offering him a peaceful retreat for composing. Here, he worked on some major pieces, including his Symphony No. 2 (premiered in 1908) and the Piano Concerto No. 3 (premiered in 1909). He continued to travel and perform widely, both in Russia and elsewhere, during this period.

After World War I began in 1914, Rachmaninoff gave numerous performances in aid of wounded soldiers and other good causes. Appropriately, his outstanding composition of the war years is a deeply serious religious work, the choral masterpiece *All-Night Vigil* (1915), often more loosely called *Vespers*. By this time, Russia was slipping into chaos and when Rachmaninoff visited Ivanovka in April 1917, he found the estate had been hit by looting and vandalism. Later that year, the Bolshevik Revolution broke out and in December Rachmaninoff escaped Russia with his wife and two children by taking up an offer to play in Stockholm. He never saw his homeland again.

Exile, travel, and legacy

From Stockholm, Rachmaninoff moved to Copenhagen, then in November 1918 to New York. He and his family had left Russia